

ISHAAN GUPTA

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Founder & Operator → VC Lens | Consumer Brands · D2C · Early-Stage Investing | IIM Bangalore & Masters' Union

EDUCATION

2025 – Present	IIM Bangalore Bachelor of Business Administration (BBA) – Business Administration & Management	Bangalore
2023-25	Masters' Union - BBA – Technology & Business Management - Ran live consumer ventures alongside academics	Gurugram
Until 2023	Delhi Public School Class 12 – Senior Secondary	India

VC RESEARCH

Feb '26 – Present	Independent VC Research – Early & Growth Stage Consumer - Tracking early-stage Indian consumer, D2C, and social startups — studying funding history, GTM strategy, and unit economics with no firm affiliation - Writing deal memos on recent raises: reconstructing investor thesis, stress testing whether disclosed metrics justify the valuation, and isolating the single biggest risk at the current stage.	
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VENTURES

Oct '23 – Aug '24	Closet Essentia – Co-Founder <i>D2C Women's Fashion</i> ₹20L revenue across, Owned product sourcing, pricing, and customer acquisition end-to-end across the full business lifecycle	Gurugram
May '25 – Sep '25	Luke Perfumes – Co-Founder <i>Offline D2C Fragrance</i> ₹6L revenue in 2 months with zero digital ad spend — built entirely through pop-ups across NCR, Developed proprietary fragrances end-to-end: concept, formulation, packaging, and pricing	Gurugram

PROJECTS

2025-26	Almost – Dating App for College Students <i>Product & Strategy Exploration</i> Identified a structural gap: existing dating apps are built for swipe volume, not for how college students actually form relationships — shared context, overlapping social graphs, verified identity, and physical proximity	MVP Stage
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SKILLS & INTERESTS

Domain	D2C brand building, unit economics, GTM strategy, venture analysis, deal memo writing, product thinking, offline retail, consumer market mapping
VC Focus	Early-stage consumer & D2C, India offline-to-online, CAC/LTV modelling, deal sourcing, cohort analysis, investment thesis writing
Interests	Indian consumer startups, margin structures, founder mistakes, GTM design, unit economic